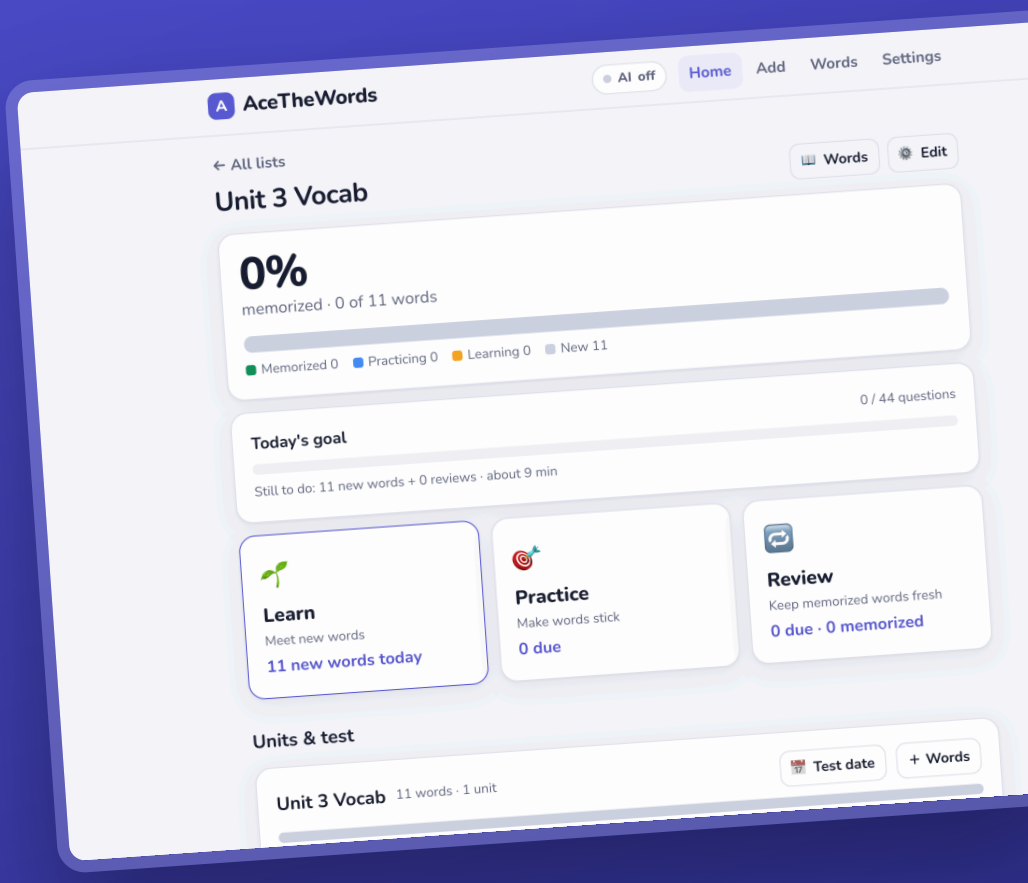
AceTheWords

User Manual

Download it, open it, and learn vocabulary for good — with smart Learn, Practice and Review sessions that bring each word back right before you'd forget it.



github.com/itsyuranwei/acethewords · Version 1.0 · November 2026

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The 30-second version

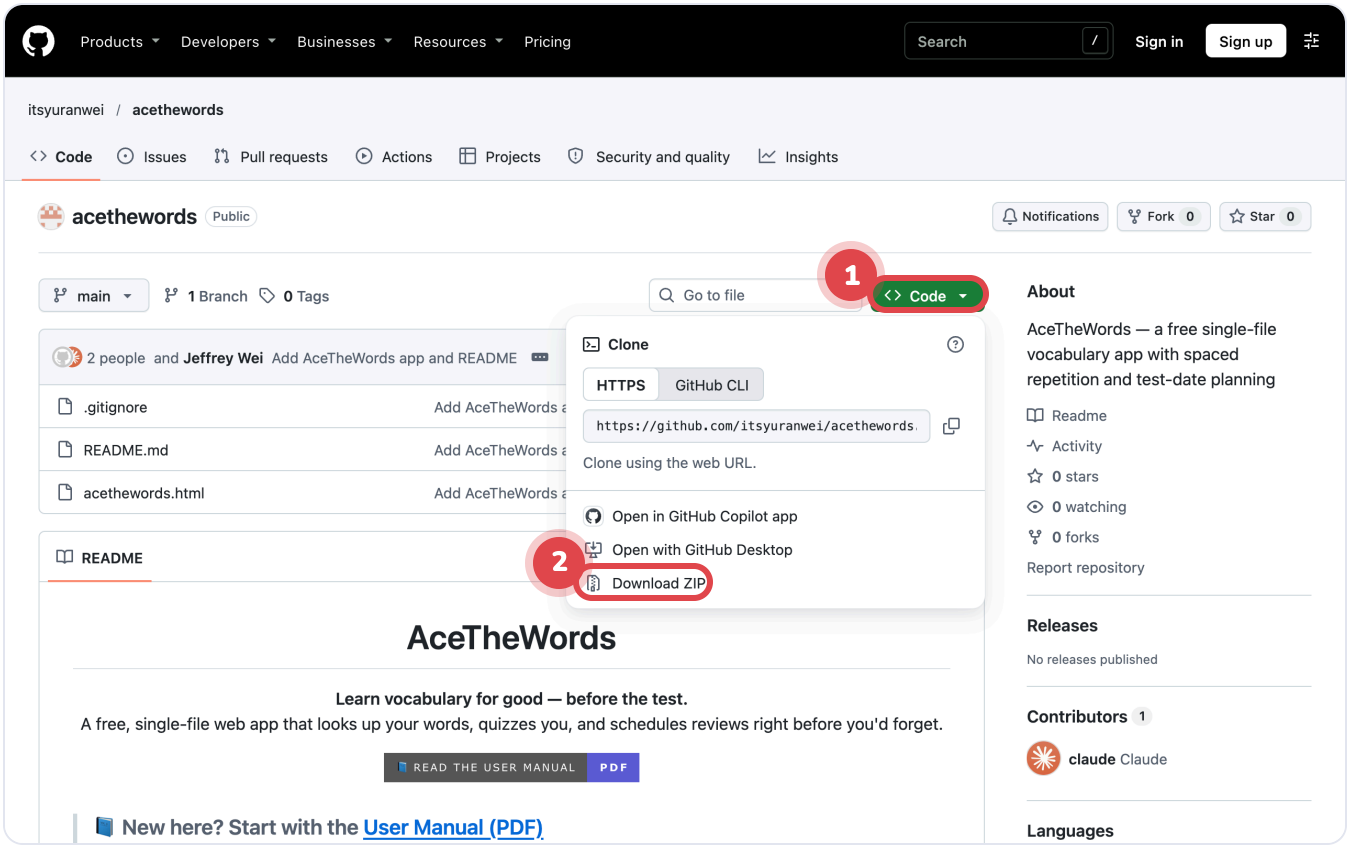
Download the ZIP from GitHub → unzip → double-click `acethewords.html` → create a list → paste your words → press **Learn**. Come back each day and do whatever the app says is due.

1 Download AceTheWords from GitHub

AceTheWords is free and lives on GitHub. The whole app is a single file, so there is nothing to install and no account to create — not even a GitHub account.

Step by step

1. Open your web browser and go to https://github.com/itsyuranwei/acethewords
2. Click the green **<> Code** button above the file list *(marker 1 below)*.
3. In the menu that opens, click **Download ZIP** *(marker 2)*. A file named `acethewords-main.zip` is saved to your **Downloads** folder.



The AceTheWords page on GitHub. The **User Manual** button in the README always links to the newest copy of this guide.

4. **Unzip the file.**
   - **Mac:** double-click `acethewords-main.zip` in Downloads. A folder called `acethewords-main` appears next to it.

- **Windows:** right-click the ZIP → **Extract All…** → **Extract**. (Opening the ZIP without extracting can stop the app from saving properly.)
- **Chromebook:** click the ZIP in the Files app, then copy the folder out of it into **My files**.

5. **Move the folder somewhere permanent**, such as *Documents*. Then you can find it again easily — and your browser keeps your progress tied to the file's location (see the note below).

> **Keep the file in one place**
> Your words and progress are saved inside your browser, linked to where `acethewords.html` lives. If you later move or re-download the file, your progress will look empty — it is not lost, it just stays with the old location. Use **Settings → Export backup** first, then **Import backup** in the new copy (Chapter 13).

Alternative: download with Git

If you already use Git, you can clone the repository instead. This also makes updating easy later (`git pull`).

```
git clone https://github.com/itsyuranwei/acethewords.git
```

Getting updates

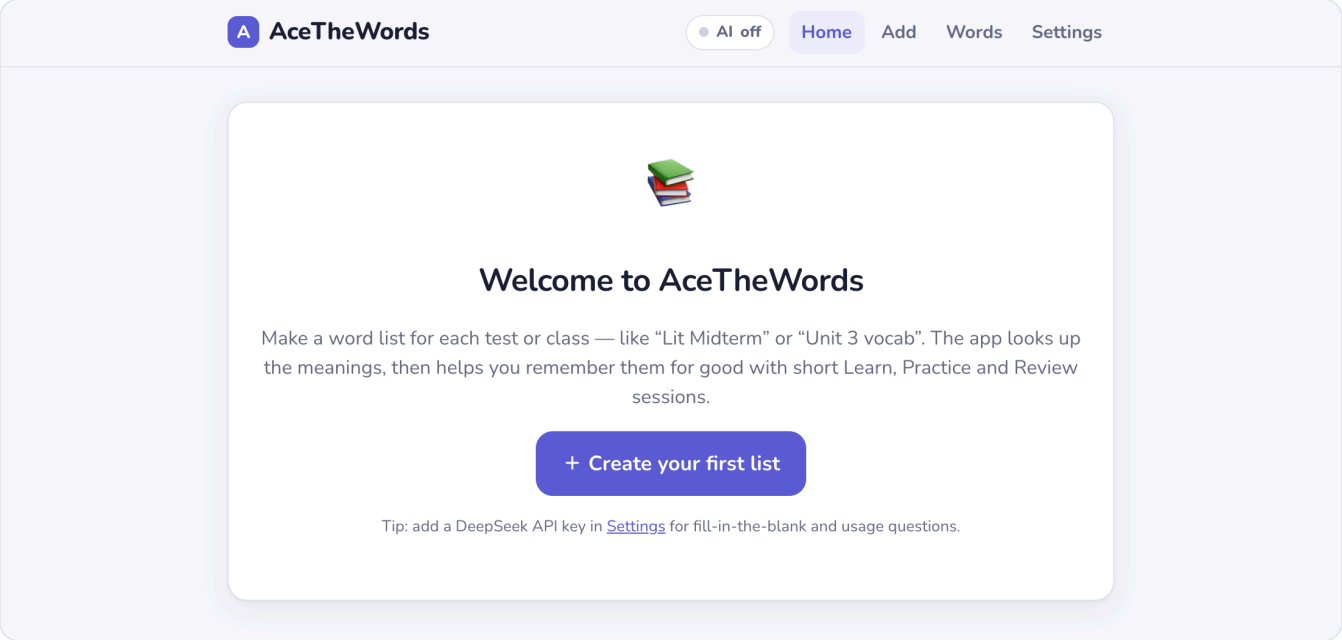
When a new version is released, export a backup, download the ZIP again, replace your old `acethewords.html` with the new one *in the same folder*, and open it. Because the location is the same, your progress is still there. If anything looks empty, import your backup.

2 Open the app

Inside the folder you just unzipped, double-click `acethewords.html`. It opens in your default web browser.

AceTheWords works in any modern browser: **Chrome, Edge, Safari or Firefox**, on Mac, Windows, Linux or a Chromebook. Pick one browser and stick with it — each browser keeps its own separate copy of your progress.

> **Make it one click away**
> Once the app is open, bookmark the page (`⌘ D` on Mac, `Ctrl D` on Windows). Next time, just click the bookmark.



The first time you open AceTheWords, you'll see the welcome screen.

A tour of the top bar

Item	What it does
AI pill	Shows whether the optional DeepSeek AI is connected: **off** (no key), **ready**, **working**, **ok** or **error**. Click it to see recent AI activity, test the connection or retry failed words. See Chapter 11.
Home	All your word lists, today's combined goal and your daily streak 🔥 .

Add	Add words to a new or existing list — typed, pasted or read from a photo.
Words	Every word you've added, with search and filters. Click a word to edit it.
Settings	AI key, daily workload, answer-speed options and backups.

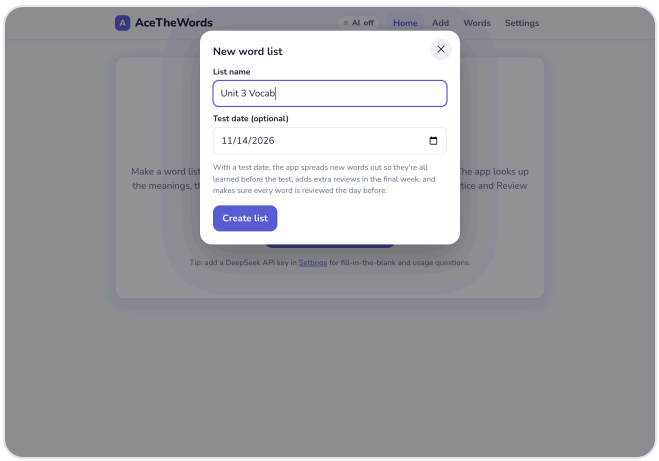
Do I need the internet?

Yes when you *add* words (meanings come from a free online dictionary) and for the AI features. Studying words you've already added works offline.

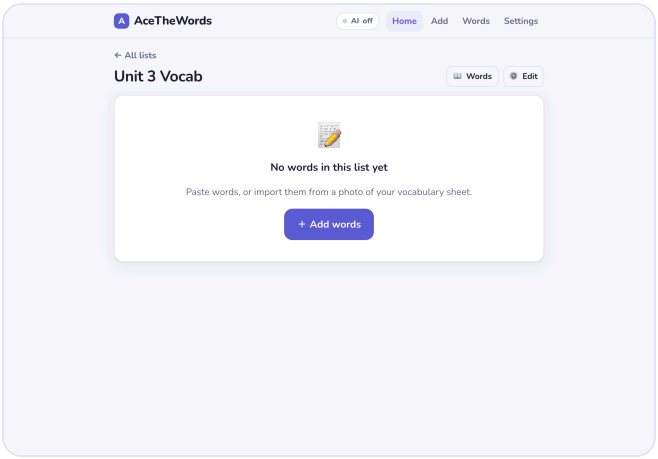
3 Create a word list

Make one list for each test or class — for example “Lit Midterm”, “SAT Week 4” or “Unit 3 Vocab”.

1. On the Home screen click **+ Create your first list** (or **+ New list** once you have some).
2. Type a **List name**.
3. Optionally pick a **Test date**. This is the most powerful setting in the app — see below.
4. Click **Create list** (or press `Enter`).



The New word list dialog.



A new, empty list — click **+ Add words**.

Why set a test date?

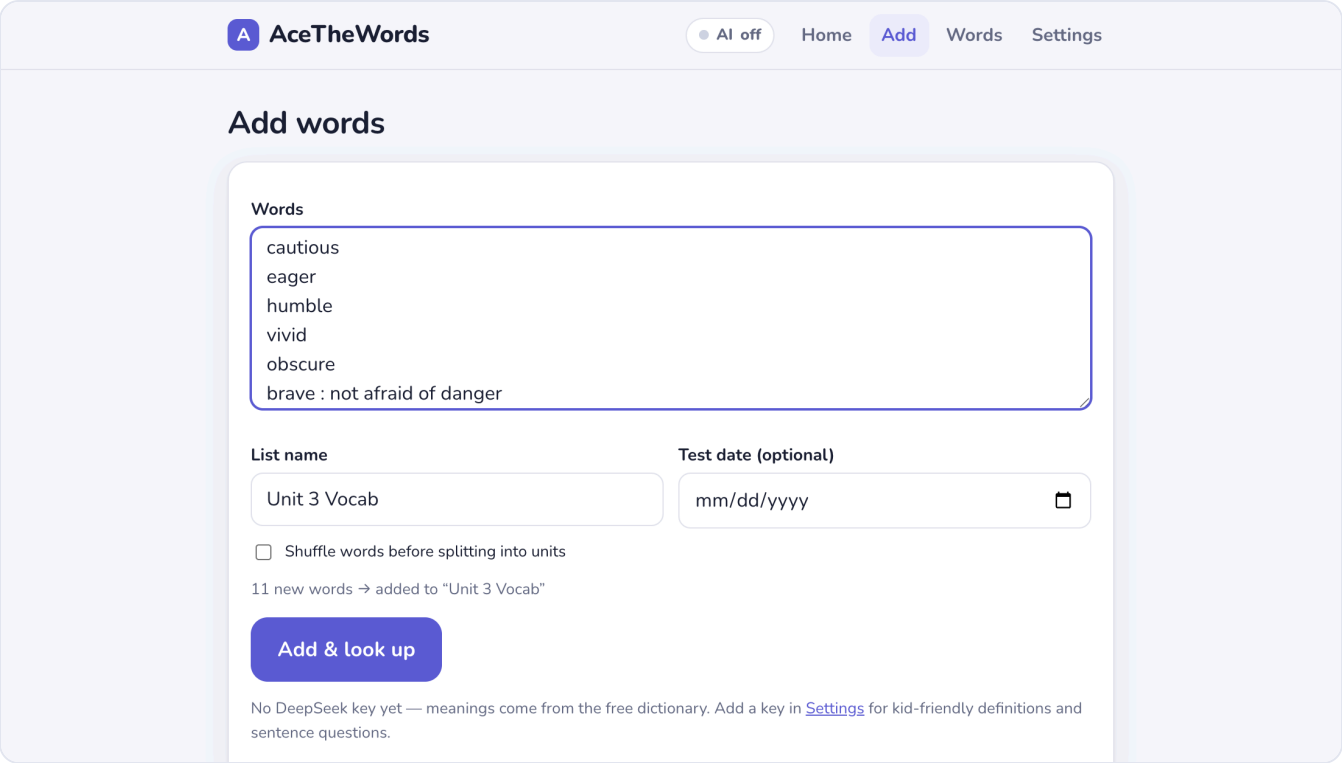
With a test date, AceTheWords plans backwards from test day. It:

- spreads new words out so **all of them are learned before the test**;
- adds **extra reviews in the final week**, when it also aims for higher recall;
- makes sure **every word is reviewed the day before** the test;
- shows a **“% ready”** score — the average predicted chance of remembering each word on test day.

You can add, change or remove the test date later with ⚙ **Edit** or 📅 **Test date** on the list's dashboard. The same dialog lets you rename or delete the list.

4 Add words

Click **Add** in the top bar (or **+ Add words** on a list). Type or paste your words, choose the list, and click **Add & look up**.



The Add words screen. A live preview under the box tells you how many words are new and how the list will be split up.

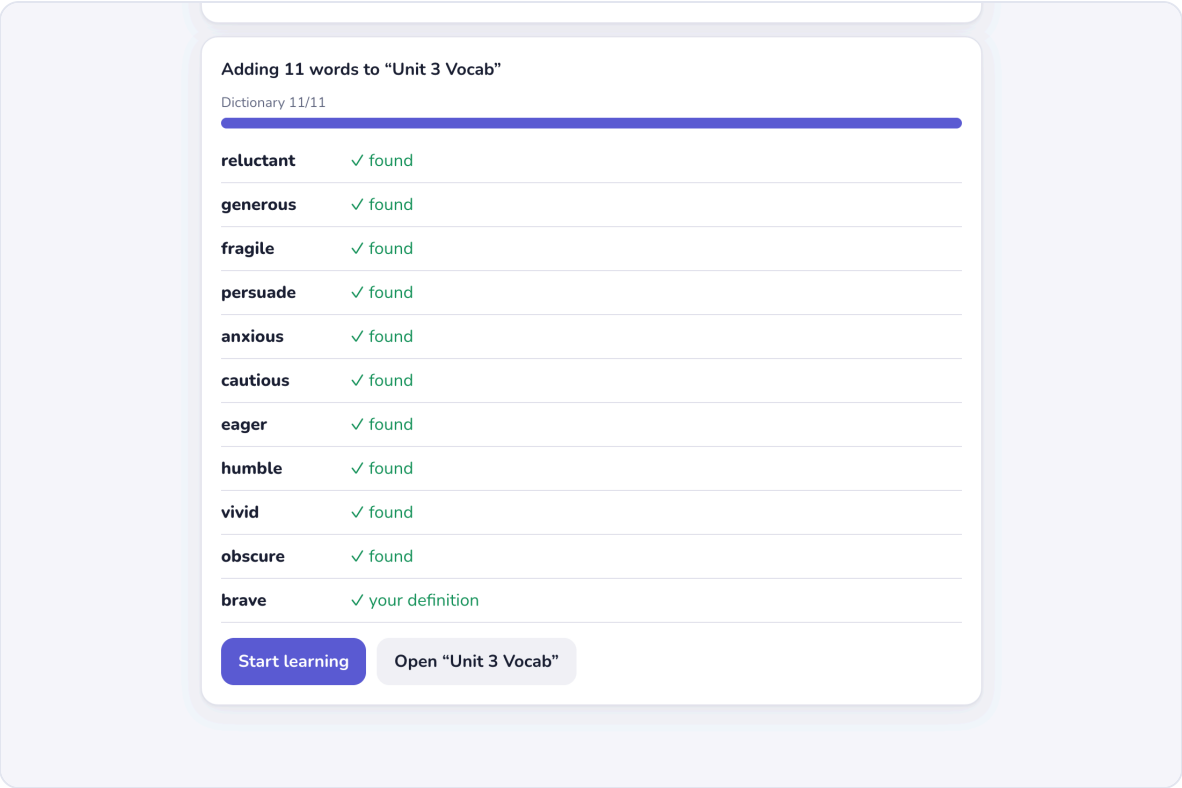
How to type your words

You type	What happens
`reluctant`	One word per line. The meaning is looked up for you.
`generous, fragile, persuade`	Several words on one line, separated by commas.
`brave : not afraid of danger`	A word, a colon, then **your own definition** — use this when your teacher gave you a specific meaning.

- **List name** — pick an existing list or type a new name to create one on the spot.
- **Test date** — only needed when you are creating a new list here.
- **Shuffle words before splitting into units** — mixes the order. Long lists are automatically split into **units** that unlock one at a time.

Watching the look-ups

After you click **Add & look up**, a progress card shows each word being looked up in the dictionary. When it finishes, click **Start learning**.



✓ found = meaning from the dictionary · ✓ your definition = the meaning you typed.

A word wasn't found?

If a word shows **✕ not in dictionary** or **✕ lookup failed**, a box appears next to it — type a definition and click **Save**. For temporary network problems, use **Settings → Retry failed lookups**.

The same word in two lists

If a word is already in another list, it is *shared*, not duplicated. Studying it in either list counts for both.

Import words from a photo

Have a printed vocabulary sheet? In the 📷 **Import from a photo** card:

1. Click **Choose files** and pick one or more photos of the list, worksheet or textbook page.
2. Optionally add **Instructions**, such as “Only the words in bold” or “Words 1–20 only”.

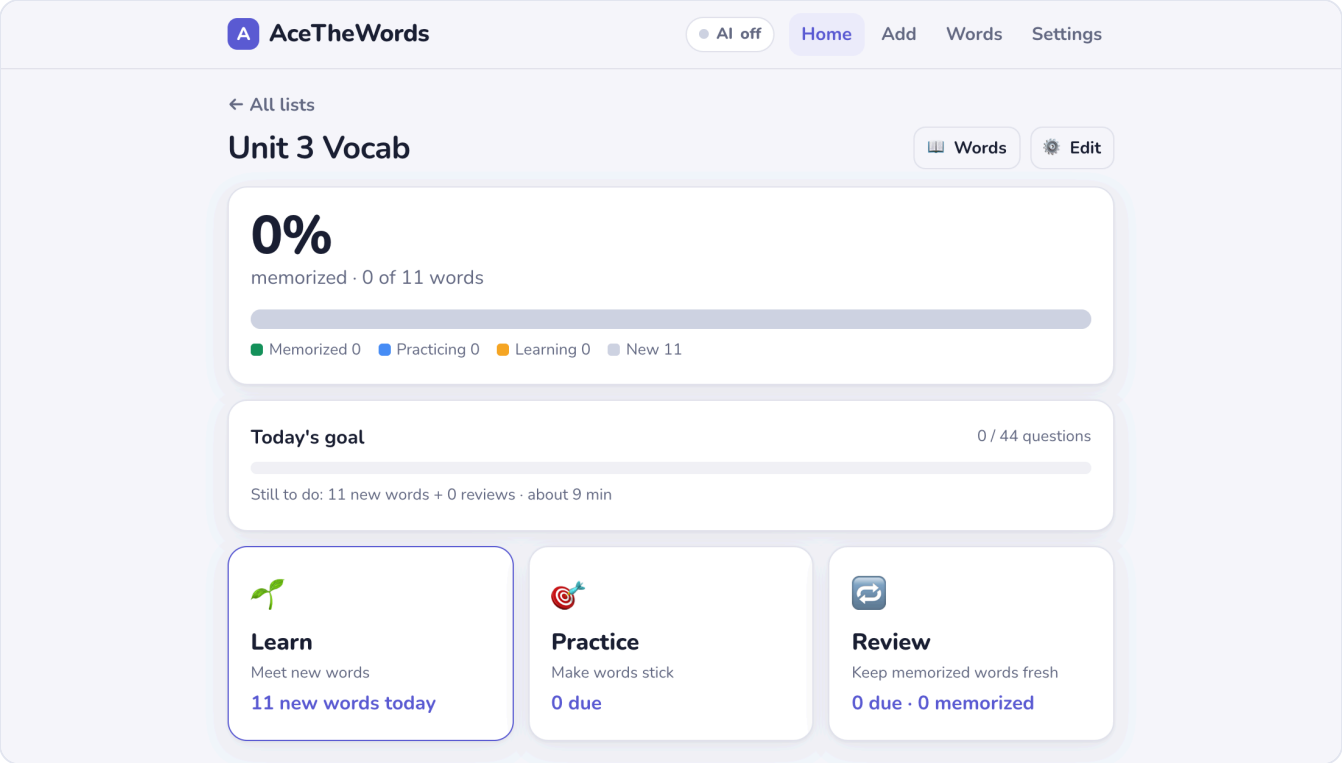
3. Tick **Keep the meanings written in the photo** if you want the sheet's definitions instead of the dictionary's.

4. Click **Read photo**. The words appear in the word box above — check them, then click **Add & look up**.

Photo import needs a DeepSeek key (Chapter 11). **No key?** Open **Use another AI instead (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini…)**, click **Copy prompt**, paste the prompt and your photo into that AI, then paste its answer into the word box.

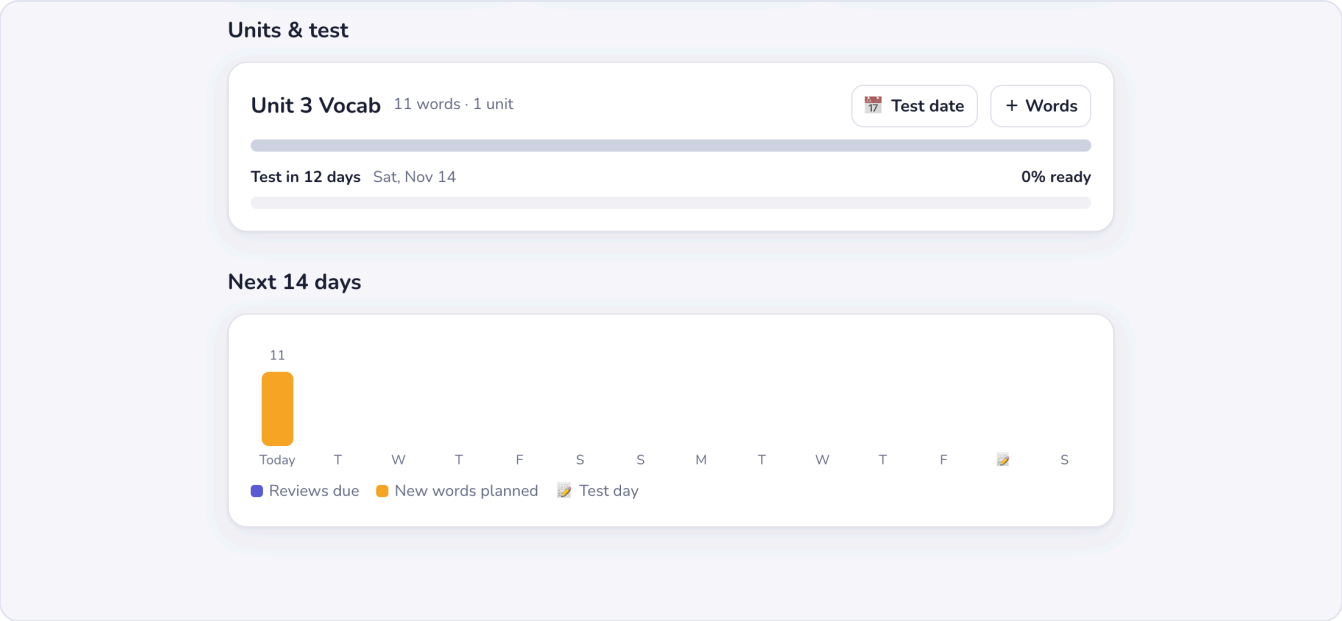
5 Your list dashboard

Click a list on the Home screen to open its dashboard. Everything about that list is here.



The dashboard for “Unit 3 Vocab”.

Section	What it shows
Big percentage	How much of the list is **memorized**, with a colored bar of every word's state (Chapter 14).
Today's goal	Questions done today out of today's plan, what's still to do, and roughly how many minutes it takes. On a busy day it tells you what can safely wait until tomorrow.
Learn · Practice · Review	The three study modes, each showing how much is waiting today. Click one to open it.
Units & test	Units and their progress, the test countdown and “% ready” score, plus any warnings (for example, too many words for the time left).
Next 14 days	A forecast chart: reviews due (purple) and new words planned (orange) for each day. 📝 marks test day.



Units & test, and the 14-day forecast.

The daily routine

Learn
Meet today's new words.

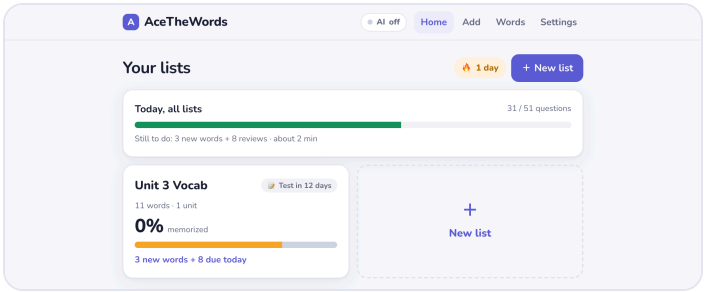
Practice
Answer what's due until the count hits 0.

Review
Refresh memorized words that are due.

That's it. A few minutes a day beats one long cram session — the app schedules everything so each word comes back just before you would forget it.

Home with several lists

The Home screen shows a tile for each list with its % memorized, test countdown, and what's due today. The **Today, all lists** card adds everything up, and the 🔥 badge counts how many days in a row you've studied.



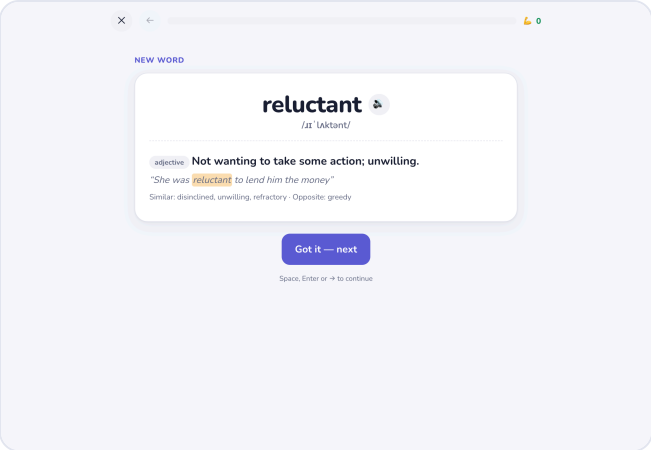
6 Learn

Learn is where you meet new words — in small batches, so they actually go in.

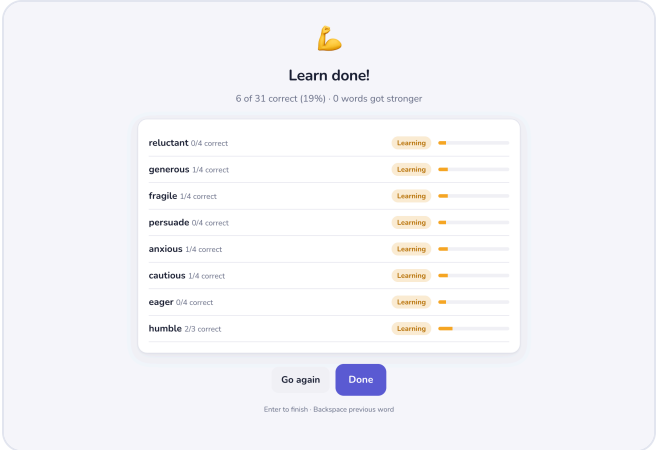
Open a list, click 🌱 **Learn**, then click the **Learn 8 words** button. (The number matches your batch size.)

How a Learn session works

1. **Meet each word.** A card shows the word, its pronunciation, meaning, an example sentence and similar/opposite words. Click 🔊 to hear it. Click **Got it — next**.
2. **Quick checks.** After you've seen the batch, the app asks short questions about each word — pick the meaning, pick the word, fill in the blank.
3. **Summary.** At the end you see how each word did. Click **Done**, or **Go again** for another round.



Meeting a new word.



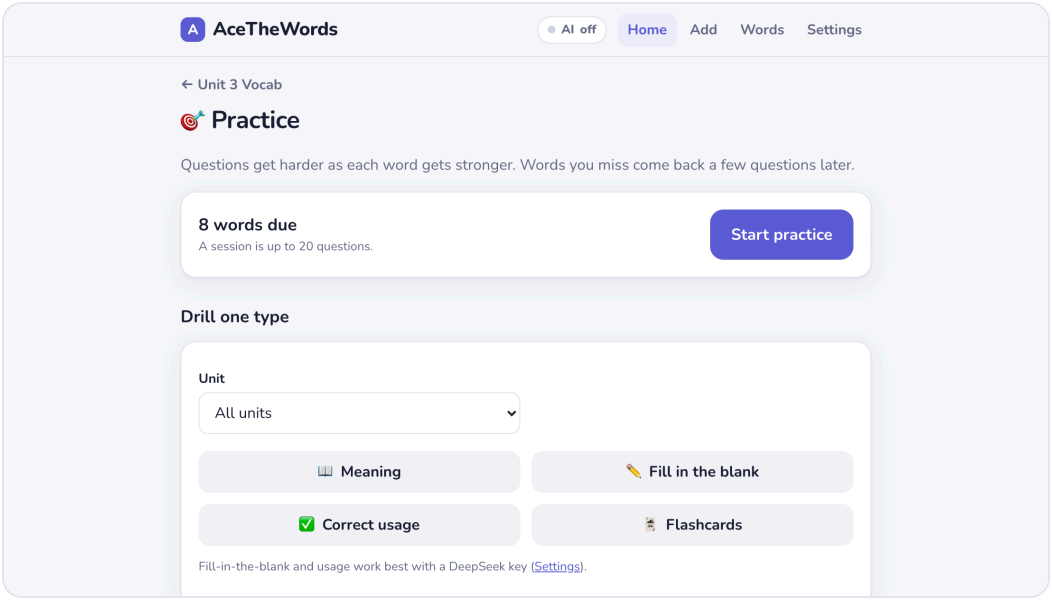
The end-of-session summary.

Daily limits and units

- The app suggests how many **new words per day** to learn. With a test date it calculates the pace needed to finish in time; without one it uses your setting (15 by default).
- When today's new words are done you'll see ✓ **Today's new words done**. You can still click **Learn … extra** if you want to get ahead.
- Long lists are split into **units**. The next unit unlocks automatically when **80%** of the current one is practiced, or you can click 🔓 **Unlock now**.

7 Practice

Practice makes newly learned words stick. Questions get harder as each word gets stronger, and words you miss come back a few questions later.



- **Start practice** — answers the words that are due now. A session is up to 20 questions (you can change this in Settings).
- **Nothing due?** Click **Extra practice** to work on your weakest words anyway.

Drill one type

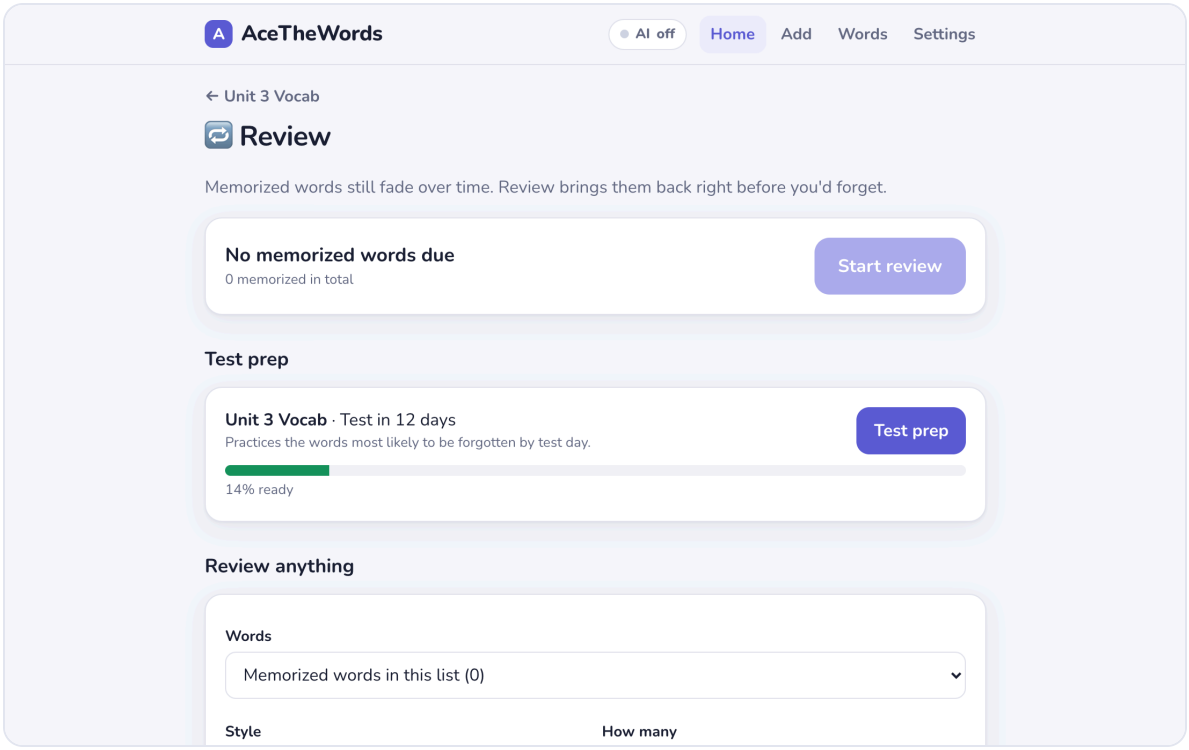
Want to focus on one skill? Choose a unit (optional) and click one of:

Drill	What you practice
📖 **Meaning**	Matching words and meanings, both directions.
✏️ **Fill in the blank**	Choosing the word that completes a sentence.
✅ **Correct usage**	Spotting which of two sentences uses the word correctly.
🗂️ **Flashcards**	Recalling the meaning yourself, then rating how well you knew it.

> **Best with AI**
>
> Fill-in-the-blank and correct-usage questions work best with a DeepSeek key, which writes fresh sentences for each word. Without it, the app uses dictionary example sentences where it can.

8 Review & test prep

Even memorized words fade. Review brings them back right before you'd forget them.



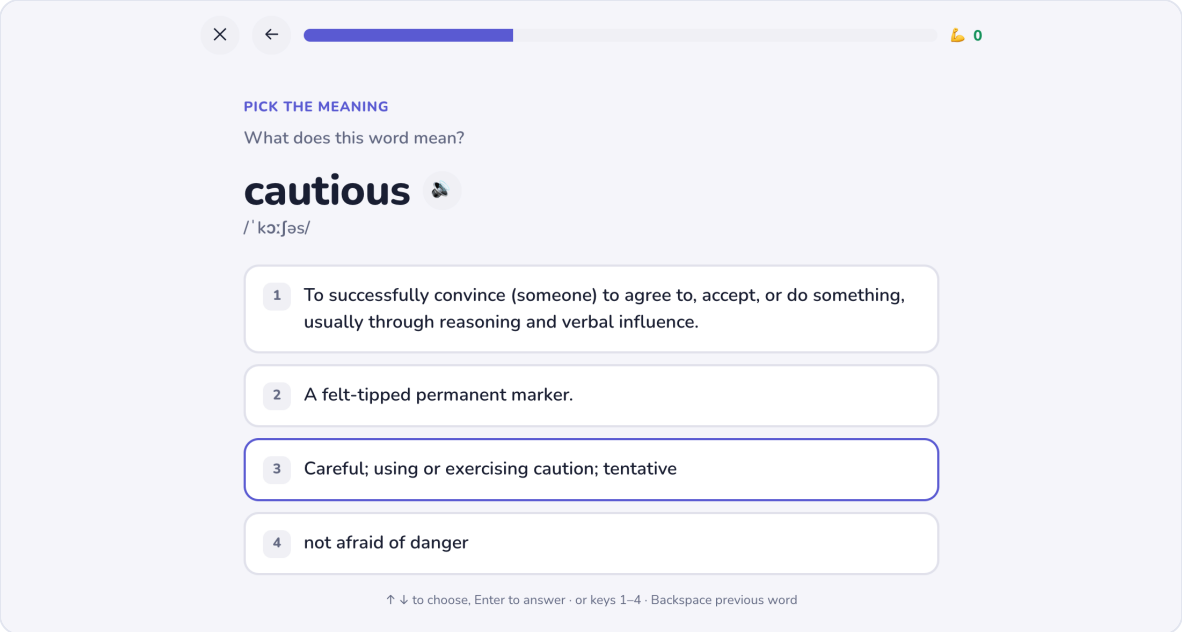
Three ways to review

Option	When to use it
Start review	Every day. Reviews the memorized words that are due now.
Test prep	Appears when a list has an upcoming test. It practices the words most likely to be forgotten by test day and shows a “% ready” bar.
Review anything	Any time. Pick which words (all memorized, all studied, a whole list or one unit), a style (**Mixed quiz** or **Flashcards**) and how many (10, 20, 30 or all), then click **Start**.

> **The night before a test**
>
> Open the list's Review page and press **Test prep**. It targets exactly the words you're most at risk of forgetting.

9 Inside a study session

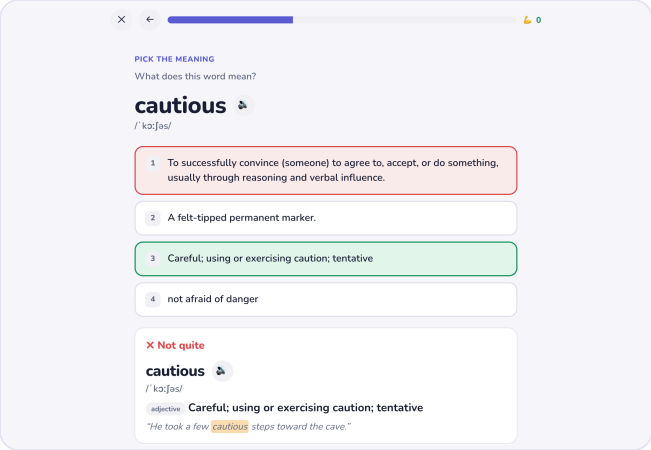
Every Learn, Practice and Review session uses the same full-screen view.



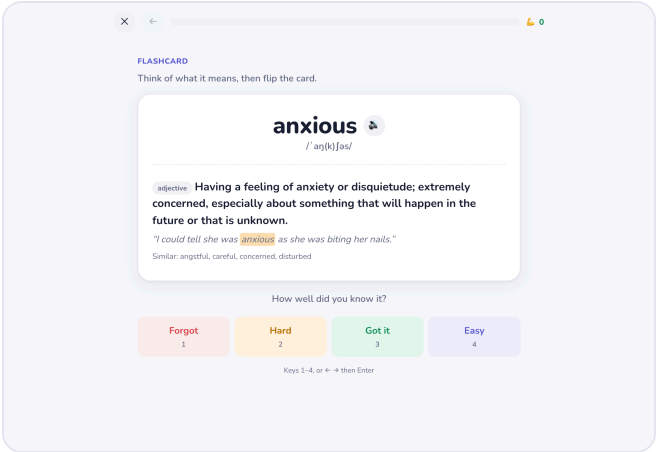
✕ exits · ← looks back at earlier words · the bar shows progress · 💪 counts words that got stronger.

Question types

Type	What you do
New word	Read the word card, then continue.
Pick the meaning	“What does this word mean?” — choose from 4 meanings. Harder versions use meanings that are easy to confuse.
Pick the word	“Which word has this meaning?” — choose from 4 words.
Fill in the blank	Choose the word that best completes the sentence.
Correct usage	“Which sentence uses the word correctly?” — choose A or B. After answering, you see why the other one is wrong.
Flashcard	Think of the meaning, flip the card, then rate yourself: **Forgot**, **Hard**, **Got it** or **Easy**. Be honest — it sets when you'll see the word again.



After you answer, the right choice is shown in green. Press **Continue**.



Rating a flashcard.

Keyboard shortcuts

You can do a whole session without touching the mouse.

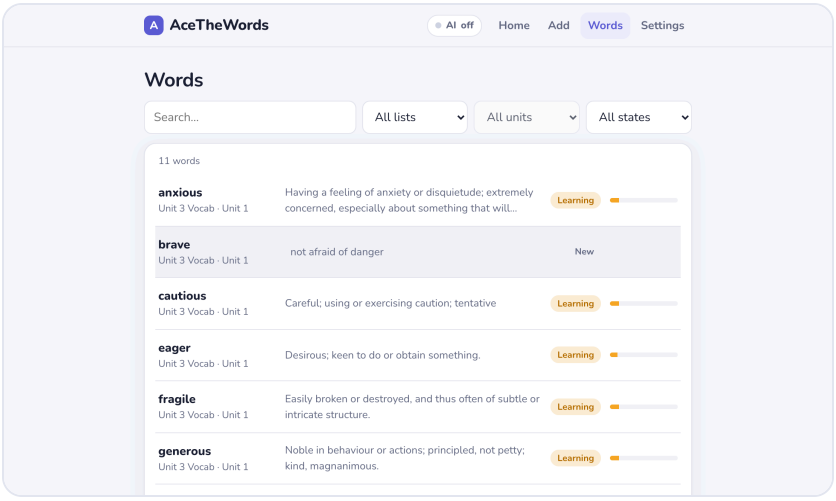
Keys	Action
`1` `2` `3` `4`	Choose an answer (or a flashcard rating once the card is flipped).
`A` `B`	Choose a sentence in a Correct usage question.
`↑` `↓` `←` `→` then `Enter`	Move the highlight between choices, then pick it.
`Space` / `Enter`	Next word · flip a flashcard · continue after answering.
`Backspace` / `←`	Look back at the previous word.
`Esc`	Exit the session (or return from looking back).

There's a hidden timer

AceTheWords quietly measures how long each answer takes. A quick, correct answer counts as stronger memory than a slow one. The timer pauses if you switch to another tab, so you won't be penalized for interruptions.

10 The Words page

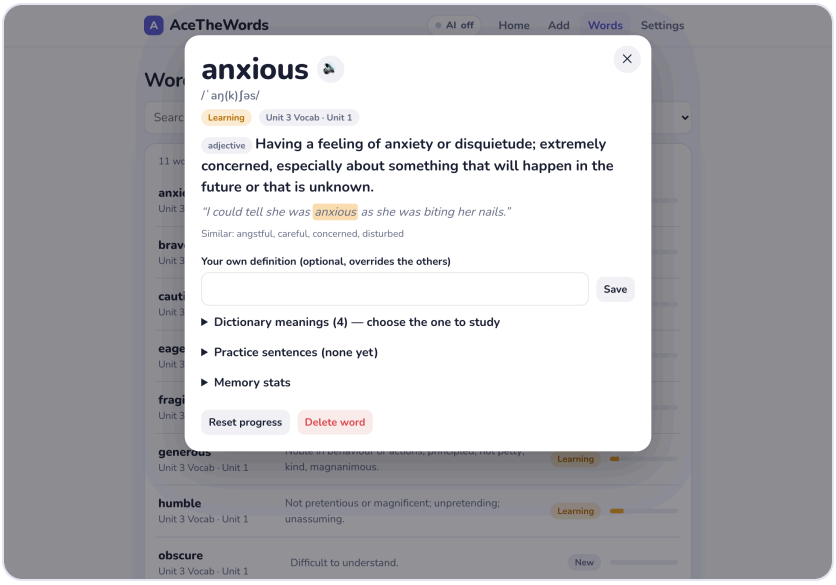
Click **Words** in the top bar to see every word you've added.



Use the search box and the filters to narrow by **list**, **unit** or **state** (New, Learning, Practicing, Memorized). Each row shows the meaning, the state and a strength bar — hover the bar to see the chance you remember it right now.

Word details

Click any word to open its details:



Part	What you can do

Lists chips	See which lists the word is in. Use **+ Add to another list…** to share it with another list, or ✕ to remove it from one (progress is kept).
Your own definition	Type a meaning and click **Save**. It replaces the dictionary meaning everywhere.
Dictionary meanings	Many words have several meanings. Click the one you need to study.
Practice sentences	The fill-in-the-blank and usage sentences. With AI on, click **Generate** or **Regenerate**.
Memory stats	How long you're likely to remember it, recall chance now, difficulty, next review date and recent answers.
Reset progress / Delete	Start the word over, or remove it completely.

11 Turn on AI (optional)

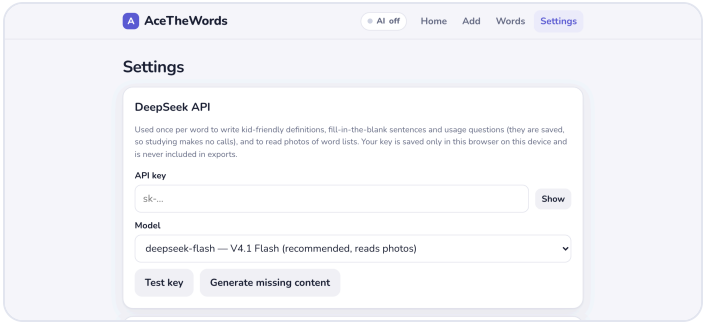
AceTheWords works without AI. Adding a DeepSeek API key unlocks extra features:

- student-friendly definitions written for your grade level;
- fresh **fill-in-the-blank** and **correct / incorrect usage** sentences for every word;
- **photo import** of vocabulary sheets.

The AI is used **once per word** when you add it; the results are saved, so studying costs nothing extra.

Set it up

1. Create an account at **platform.deepseek.com**, add a small balance, and create an **API key** (it starts with `sk-`).
2. In AceTheWords, go to **Settings → DeepSeek API** and paste the key into **API key**.
3. Leave **Model** on **deepseek-flash** (recommended — it's cheaper and can read photos).
4. Click **Test key**. You should see **✓ Key works**, and the AI pill in the top bar turns to **ready**.
5. Already added words before you had a key? Click **Generate missing content**.



> **Keep your key private**
> Your key is saved only in this browser on this device. It is **never** included in backup exports, so you can share backups safely. Words you add and photos you import are sent to DeepSeek to write the questions.

Checking the AI connection

Click the **AI** pill in the top bar to see recent requests, **Test connection** or **Retry failed words**. Error **402**: top up your balance. **401/403**: wrong key.

12 Settings

The defaults work well for most students. If you change things and want to go back, click **Use recommended settings**.

Student

Setting	Default	What it means
Grade level	Grade 11	How simple the AI-written definitions and sentences are (Grades 3–12).
Target recall	90%	How sure the app wants to be that you still remember a word before reviewing it. Higher = more reviews. It rises automatically in the week before a test.
New words per day	15	Used for lists without a test date. Lists with a test date calculate their own pace.
Daily question limit	100	The most questions planned for one day. Extra reviews move to the next day.
Practice session length	20	Questions per Practice session (5–60).
Learn batch size	8	New words per Learn session (3–100). 5–10 is easiest to remember.
Quick checks per new word	2 of 3	How many check questions follow each new word in Learn.

Answer speed

When **Use answer speed for scheduling** is on, quick right answers push the next review later, while slow answers — or answers too fast to have been read — bring it sooner. A small model learns from your own answers how much speed matters for you. **Reset speed model** starts it over.

Data

Export backup, **Import backup**, **Retry failed lookups** and **Erase everything** — see the next chapter.

13 Back up your progress

Your words and progress are saved automatically in your browser. Back them up now and then so they're safe if browser data is cleared.

Export a backup

1. Go to **Settings → Data**.
2. Click **Export backup**. A file named like `acethewords-backup-2026-11-02.json` is downloaded.
3. Keep it somewhere safe — cloud storage, email it to yourself, or a USB drive.

Import a backup (or move to another computer)

1. On the new computer, download and open AceTheWords (Chapters 1–2).
2. Go to **Settings → Data → Import backup** and choose your backup file.
3. A message confirms how many words were added and updated. Importing **merges** with what's already there — it doesn't wipe it.
4. Paste your DeepSeek key again if you use AI (keys are never in backups).

> **Things that erase browser data**
> Clearing your browser's history or site data, using a private/incognito window, or some “cleaner” apps can remove your progress. A recent backup means you lose nothing.

Erase everything

Settings → Data → Erase everything deletes all lists, words and progress after asking you to confirm. It cannot be undone, so export a backup first. Your DeepSeek key is kept.

14 How AceTheWords remembers

You don't need to know this to use the app — but it explains why words show up when they do.

The four word states

State	Meaning
New	Added but not studied yet.
Learning	You've met the word; it's still fragile.
Practicing	Getting stronger with practice on different days.
Memorized	Stable enough, recalled on **3 separate days**, and passed a **hard** question. Memorized words still get occasional reviews.

Spaced repetition

AceTheWords uses **FSRS-5**, the memory model behind Anki's modern scheduler. For every word it tracks:

- **Stability** — how many days until your chance of remembering drops to 90%;
- **Difficulty** — how hard this word is for you (1–10);
- **Recall now** — the predicted chance you'd get it right at this moment.

Each correct answer makes a word more stable, so its next review comes later. Correct answers to **harder questions** and after **longer gaps** grow stability the most — these are the well-studied *testing* and *spacing* effects. Wrong answers bring the word back soon.

> **What this means for you**
>
> Do a little every day, answer honestly, and trust the schedule. Seeing a word again “just as you were about to forget it” is exactly what makes it stick.

15 Troubleshooting & FAQ

My lists disappeared!

Most likely you opened `acethewords.html` from a different folder, a different browser, or a private window. Open the original file in your usual browser. If browser data was cleared, use **Import backup**.

Do I need a GitHub account to download it?

No. Anyone can click **Code → Download ZIP** on the GitHub page.

Is it free?

Yes. The only optional cost is DeepSeek usage if you add an API key — typically a tiny amount per word, paid to DeepSeek directly.

Some words say “lookup failed”.

Check your internet connection, then click **Settings → Retry failed lookups**. For words the dictionary doesn't know (names, rare words), type your own definition.

The dictionary picked the wrong meaning.

Open the word on the **Words** page, expand **Dictionary meanings** and click the right one — or type **Your own definition**.

There's too much to do today.

The Today's goal card shows what can wait until tomorrow. You can also lower **New words per day** or the **Daily question limit** in Settings. If a list has a test date, a warning appears when the workload is heavy.

Can I use it on my phone or tablet?

The app's layout works on small screens. Opening a downloaded HTML file on a phone varies by device, and progress on the phone is separate from your computer — move it with Export / Import backup.

Can two students share one computer?

Give each student their own browser profile (or their own browser). Each keeps separate progress.

Where can I report a problem or get the newest version?

Visit github.com/itsyuranwei/acethewords. The newest app and this manual are always there.

> **Happy studying!**
> A few focused minutes a day is all it takes. Go ace those words. ✨